William Timkey

Curriculum Vitae

Department of Linguistics
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Education

2022–present **PhD, Linguistics**, *New York University*, Advisor: Tal Linzen.

2017–2022 : **Bachelor of Arts, Linguistics**, *Cornell University*, With Distinction, GPA: 4.075.
Transferred in from SUNY Buffalo

Other Education (Non-degree)

2021–2022 : **Korean Language Student**, *Seoul National University KLEC*.

2016–2017 : **Bachelor of Science, Computer Science**, *SUNY Buffalo*, Advanced Honors Program, GPA: 4.000.

Publications

Journal Articles (in review)

2026 William Timkey, Brian Dillon, and Tal Linzen. Why are language models less surprised than humans? Testing the Parse Multiplicity Mismatch Hypothesis. In review, preprint available, May 2026.

2025 William Timkey, Kuan-Jung Huang, Byung-Doh Oh, Grusha Prasad, Suhas Arehalli, Tal Linzen, and Brian Dillon. Eye movements reveal a dissociation between prediction and structural processing in language comprehension. In review, preprint available, November 2025.

Conference Proceedings

2023 **Timkey, William** and Tal Linzen. A language model with limited memory capacity captures interference in human sentence processing. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2023*, pages 8705–8720, Singapore, December 2023. Association for Computational Linguistics.

2021 Matt Wilber, **Timkey, William**, and Marten van Schijndel. To point or not to point: Understanding how abstractive summarizers paraphrase text. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL-IJCNLP 2021*, pages 3362–3376, Online, August 2021. Association for Computational Linguistics.

2021 **Timkey, William** and Marten van Schijndel. All bark and no bite: Rogue dimensions in transformer language models obscure representational quality. In *Proceedings of the 2021 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*, pages 4527–4546, Online and Punta Cana, Dominican Republic, November 2021. Association for Computational Linguistics.

Other Conference Presentations

2026 **William Timkey,** Kuan-Jung Huang, Byung-Doh Oh, Grusha Prasad, Suhas Arehalli, Tal Linzen, Brian Dillon, Prediction and structural processing dissociate: A large-scale eyetracking study , In *The 39th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing*.

2025 **William Timkey** and Tal Linzen, Language model surprisal underpredicts garden path effects even with limited syntactic parallelism, In *The 38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing*.

2024 **William Timkey**, Kuan-Jung Huang, Grusha Prasad, Suhas Arehalli, Tal Linzen, Brian Dillon, Large-scale eye-tracking while reading benchmark shows surprisal captures early fixations, but not regressions, In *The 37th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing*.

Invited Talks

2026 *Title TBD.* MIT Computational Psycholinguistics Lab, Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2026 *Using neural language models to test theories of human sentence processing.* Laboratoire de Sciences Cognitives et Psycholinguistique (LSCP), École Normale Supérieure

2025 *What a large-scale eye tracking benchmark reveals about syntactic reanalysis in reading.* Sentence Processing Workshop, University of Potsdam

2025 *Using Neural Networks to Model Syntactic Dependency Resolution Difficulty in Human Sentence Processing* Psycholinguistics group, University of Massachusetts, Amherst

2024 *What can LMs tell us about how humans resolve syntactic dependencies?* Interpretable, Cognitively inspired, Low-resource Language Models (InClow Lab), University of Groningen

2024 *Toward a rational model of working memory in parsing.* Language, Computation, and Cognition Lab (LaCoCo), Saarland University

2024 *Toward a rational model of cue-based retrieval* Joint UMass/UMD Psycholinguistics Workshop, University of Massachusetts, Amherst

Research Positions

Aug 2022 – Present **Computation and Psycholinguistics Lab, New York University**, PhD Student.
Advisor: Prof. Tal Linzen

Jan 2025 – Present **Computational Sentence Processing Lab, University of Massachusetts, Amherst**, Visiting PhD Student.
Advisor: Prof. Brian Dillon

Aug 2020 – Dec 2021 **Computational Psycholinguistics Research Discussions Group (C.Psyd), Cornell University**, Research assistant.
Advisor: Prof. Marten van Schijndel

Aug 2020 – Apr 2021 **Department of Linguistics, Cornell University**, Historian.
Advisor: Prof. John B. Whitman

Aug 2019 – Jan 2020 **Department of Information Science, Cornell University**, Independent Research.
Advisor: Prof. David Mimno

May 2019 – Jan 2020 **Human-Computer Interaction Institute, Carnegie Mellon University**, Research Intern.
Advisors: Prof. Brad Myers and Prof. Toby Li

May 2019 – Jan 2020 **Collaborative Technologies Lab, Cornell University**, Research Assistant.
Advisors: Prof. Susan Fussell

Service

Positions

2023-2024 **Secretary** *The Linguistics Association of NYU (LANYU)*

2023 **Graduate School Application Panel** *Department of Linguistics, New York University*

2024 **Bibliography Workshop Organizer** *Department of Linguistics, New York University*

2020 **Volunteer** *Conference on Emperical Methods in Natural Language Processing*

Ad-hoc Journal Reviewing

2026 Open Mind

2026 Glossa Psycholinguistics

2025 Cognition

2024 Journal of Memory and Language

Undergraduate Advising

2026 Lukeria Petrunina, NYU Lingusitics

Teaching

Spring, 2026: **LING-UA 61: Human Sentence Processing**, *New York University*, Teaching Assistant.

Fall, 2024: **LING-UA 27: Language and Mind**, *New York University*, Teaching Assistant.

Fall, 2023: **LING-UA 27: Language and Mind**, *New York University*, Teaching Assistant.

Fall, 2021: **STAT 104: Introduction to Quantitative Methods for Economics**, *Harvard University*, Teaching Fellow.

Summer, 2021: **STAT 100: Introduction to Quantitative Methods**, *Harvard University*, Teaching Fellow.

Spring, 2021: **STAT 102: Introduction to Quantitative Methods for Life Sciences**, *Harvard University*, Teaching Fellow.

Fall, 2020: **STAT 104: Introduction to Quantitative Methods for Economics**, *Harvard University*, Teaching Fellow.

Summer, 2020: **STAT 100: Introduction to Quantitative Methods**, *Harvard University*, Teaching Fellow.

Spring, 2020: **INFO 2950: Introduction to Data Science**, *Cornell University*, Teaching Assistant.

Fall, 2017: **CS 199: Introductory Computer Science Seminar**, *SUNY Buffalo*, Teaching Assistant.

Awards

2026 NYU Faculty of Arts and Sciences Dean's Conference Fund Award Recipient

2025 NYU Faculty of Arts and Sciences Dean's Conference Fund Award Recipient

2022-present NYU Graduate School of Arts and Sciences Henry M. Mccracken Fellowship

2022 Seoul National University KLEC Academic Honor Scholarship

2019 Erasmus Mundus scholarship (declined due to COVID-19 pandemic travel restrictions)

2017 SUNY Buffalo Advanced Honors College

2017 SUNY Buffalo Provost Scholarship

Skills

Programming Languages: python (pytorch, pandas etc.), R (lme, brms, etc.), SQL, Java, HTML, CSS, javascript, PHP

Human Languages: **English** (native), **Korean** (high intermediate/advanced), **German** (low intermediate)